



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

§ 845. *idam ayuktam vartate. kim atrāyuktam? jñānāvaraṇe satyajñānapariśaha upapadyate, prajñāpariśahaḥ punas tadapāye bhavatīti katham jñānāvaraṇe syāt? ity atrocyate — kṣāyopaśamikī prajñā anyasmin jñānāvaraṇe sati madam janayati na sakalāvaraṇakṣaye iti jñānāvaraṇe satīty upapadyate.*

— Sarvārthasiddhi [Śrīmadācāryagr̥ddhapicchapraṇītasya tattvārthasūtrasya vṛttiḥ = Commentary on the Tattvārthasūtra], atha navamo 'dhyāyaḥ (Chapter 9), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

This passage from the Sarvārthasiddhi addresses a seemingly paradoxical situation regarding spiritual progress and the experience of hardship. Specifically, it questions how "prajñāpariśaha," the hardship arising from wisdom or insight, can occur when there is still "jñānāvaraṇa," the obscuration of knowledge. One might logically think that the hardship of wisdom only arises once the obscuration of knowledge is removed.

The commentary clarifies this apparent contradiction by introducing the concept of "kṣāyopaśamikī prajñā," which is partially subsided and partially operative wisdom. This type of wisdom, arising when the obscuration of knowledge is only partially diminished, can actually give rise to pride or arrogance ("madam janayati"). It's not the complete, pure wisdom that leads to humility and liberation, but rather a limited understanding that can inflate the ego. The text emphasizes that this pride doesn't arise from the complete removal of the veil of ignorance, but during its partial removal.

This is profoundly relevant to your own spiritual journey. You might experience moments of insight and feel a sense of superior understanding. Perhaps you grasp a philosophical concept or have a profound meditative experience. It's easy to become attached to this feeling of knowing and let it inflate your ego. The Sarvārthasiddhi warns against this. True wisdom isn't about accumulating knowledge or having fleeting moments of insight, but about dismantling the ego itself. A little bit of knowledge can be a dangerous thing if it fuels pride and separates you from others. Recognize these moments when your ego latches onto your spiritual progress. Cultivate humility and remember that the path to enlightenment is a continuous process of unveiling, not a destination to be attained. Embrace the ongoing journey of learning and unlearning, allowing your understanding to deepen without inflating your sense of self.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are there areas in your life where you might be clinging to partial knowledge, allowing it to fuel pride rather than fostering genuine humility and connection?